DATA ITEM DESCRIPTION

Form Approved
OMB No. 0704-0188

2. TITLE	1. IDENTIFICATION NUMBER
Operating Instructions	DI-MISC-80392

3. DESCRIPTION / PURPOSE

3.1 Operating Instructions (OIs) are used to announce policies, assign responsibilities, direct actions, and prescribe procedures. They are necessary to ensure accomplishment of specific and discrete tasks as required by several functional areas such as communications, maintenance, transportation, etc.

4. APPROVAL DATE (YYMMDD)	5. OFFICE OF PRIMARY RESPONSIBILITY (OPR)	6a. DTIC REQUIRED	6b. GIDEP REQUIRED
870730	F/AFSPACECOM-DAP		

7. APPLICATION / INTERRELATIONSHIP

7.1 This data item description (DID) contains the format and content preparation instructions for the data product generated by the specific and discrete task requirement as delineated in the contract.

7.2 This DID is applicable to all contracts including functional requirements to produce OIs.

8. APPROVAL LIMITATION	9a. APPLICABLE FORMS	9b. AMSC NUMBER
		F4158

10. PREPARATION INSTRUCTIONS

10.1 Format. All OIs shall be prepared in the format shown at Figure 1.

10.2 Content Instructions and Information.

10.2.1 Propriety and Good Taste. Terms and titles in an OI must not be used when they:

a. Could discredit the Government subject it to public ridicule.

b. May offend readers of either sex or of any race, age group, religion, political affiliation, or nationality.

c. Have an adverse impact on an individual because of minority discrimination or unnecessary sex-based distinctions. Note: A policy or procedure may appear to be neutral, yet contain misleading language that is discriminatory.

d. Continue to show obsolete, stereotyped roles of personnel in the work force, or that are demeaning or misleading.

(Continued on Page 2)

11. DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

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DEPARTMENT OF THE AIR FORCE
Contract Number _____

ADMINISTRATION OPERATING INSTRUCTION 5-1

11 May 1987

Publications Management

PUBLISHING OPERATING INSTRUCTIONS

This instruction prescribes the general and specific instructions that are to be followed when contractors must prepare operating instructions (OIs).

1. **Media and Format.** (Refer to Air Force Regulations 5-1, 5-4 and 5-8, or other services regulations for additional guidance.)

2. _____.

3. _____.

4. _____.

5. _____.

6. **Summary of Changes.** Changes all format and preparation instructions.

JOHN T. THOMAS, Captain, USAF
Site Commander

_____
Supersedes AOI 5-1, 30 July 1986
OPR: DAP (Mr C. D. Jones)
Distribution: X

FIGURE 1. Sample OI.

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10. Preparation Instructions (continued):

10.2.2 Sex-neutral language. Sex-neutral language must be used whenever possible.

a. Avoid using male-oriented job titles. Avoid using male-oriented terms where general terms can be used.

b. Use singular pronouns when possible. Avoid using he or she, his or her, and him or her, unless unavoidable. Use titles or plural pronouns instead. Use gender related pronouns when distinguishing between men and women.

c. Do not use third-person - singular pronouns. For example, do not use "he" when referring to a commander or "she" when referring to a nurse or a secretary.

d. Use interchangeable words that still convey the meaning of the text. Use they, them or their to avoid making sex distinctions.

e. Don't use contrived words, such as "freshperson" for "freshman".

10.2.3 Sample forms, names. Do not use joke or gag names for persons, installations, or office designations. These commonly appear in sample forms, formats, and letters. Instead of using an unusual name, use a common one. In referring to the location of an activity, use the actual installation name including state and ZIP code.

10.2.4 Copyrighted material. Don't use copyrighted material or material contributed or loaned by nongovernment sources unless the required copyright release or author's permission has been obtained.

a. If copyrighted material is used, at the foot of the title page, centered below all other information, place the statement: This publication contains copyrighted material.

b. In the text, place an asterisk at the beginning of the copyrighted material and in a footnote on the same page to show the name of the copyrighted work, the year the work was first published, the copyright symbol, and the name of the owner of the copyrighted work (the name on the copyright release).

10.2.5 Trade names. Do not use a trade name or the name of a commercial service in any operating instruction.

10.2.6 Restrictive requirements. Do not impose overly restrictive requirements in an operating instruction. Common sense must dictate the proper amount of control necessary to accomplish a task.

10.2.7 Duplication. Do not duplicate Goverment regulations in OIs.

10.2.8 Abbreviations. Use abbreviations only to avoid frequently repeating a word or phrase. The first time an abbreviation is used in an OI, show the word or phrase followed by its abbreviation in parentheses.

10.2.9 Illustrations. Do not use illustrations in OIs unless there is a demonstrated need. If it is necessary to use illustrations, refer to them as figures, tables or attachments as appropriate. All illustrations must be cited in the text and placed as near as possible to the first paragraph that refers to them.

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10. Preparation Instructions (continued):

10.2.10 Understandable OIs. Comply with plain English standards.

a. Use words that are clear and simple; avoid abstract or technical words or jargon.

b. Write in the active voice.

c. Write clear, grammatical sentences that are short, usually no longer than 20 words.

d. Use the same tense, person, and voice consistently throughout a paragraph.

e. Present the material in a logical, orderly sequence.

f. Keep the organization simple. Avoid complicated subparagraphs.

g. Avoid multisyllable words whenever short words will do. Common sense dictates that a reader cannot follow instructions that are not understandable.

10.3 Specific Instructions.

10.3.1 Media and Format. OIs are used to provide policy and regulatory material and procedures.

a. Margins. Top margin = ½ inch; bottom margin = 1 inch; inside margin =1½inch; outside margin = ½ inch.

b. Purpose Statement. A short purpose statement shall be included in each OI. Limit to not more than three or four sentences. Placement is as shown in Figure 1.

c. Numbering System. Numbering of OIs shall be as determined by the contractor. However, each type of OI, such as Communications OIs (COIs), Maintenance OIs (MOIs), etc, shall be numbered seperately.

d. Summary of Changes. A summary of changes may be included as the last paragraph in an OI. This is optional.

e. Footer. Supersession line is mandatory. Office of Primary Responsibility (OPR) line and Distribution line are both optional. If used place below supersession line.

f. Signature Block. Signature blocks will conform to the example in Figure 1, however, the individual who actually signs the document will be as indicated in DD Forms 1423.

10.4 Revision. Revisions or changes shall be consistent with the original or basic documents.

10.5 Indexes. Indexes for each series (i.e. COIs, MOIs TOIs, CEOIs. etc) shall be in the same general format as OIs being indexed.

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